

Expansion of British Rule in India

Bengal's Nawabs, Buxar & the Diwani, Doctrine of Lapse, Subsidiary Alliance and the annexation of Punjab, Awadh, Burma & the Marathas (1700–1856)

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Why this chapter matters: This is the single densest static-GK block in Modern History for SSC exams — a chain of Nawabs, battles, treaties and annexation policies that all connect to each other. Once you see the chain (Plassey → Buxar → Allahabad → Diwani → Doctrine of Lapse → 1857), the individual dates stop feeling random.

1 The Nawabs of Bengal — the Full Lineage 🔥

Bengal (which then included today's Bangladesh and Odisha) became a separate power centre inside the declining Mughal Empire in the early 18th century.

Year	Event
1700	Aurangzeb appoints Murshid Quli Khan as Governor (Diwan) of Bengal
1704	Murshid Quli Khan shifts Bengal's capital from Dhaka to Murshidabad
1707	Aurangzeb dies
1717	Murshid Quli Khan declares Bengal an independent province (weak Mughal emperor Farrukhsiyar could not stop him) — becomes Bengal's first Nawab

MEMORY TRICK

"My Sister Sells Apples, Silly Merchants Quarrel" — Murshid Quli Khan (1717–27) → Shuja-ud-Din (1727–39) → Sarfaraz Khan (1739–40) → Alivardi Khan (1740–56) → Siraj-ud-Daulah (1756–57) → Mir Jafar (1757–60) → Qasim, i.e. Mir Qasim (1760–63).

Nawab	Tenure	Note
Murshid Quli Khan	1717–1727	First Nawab; founder of Bengal as a province
Shuja-ud-Din	1727–1739	—
Sarfaraz Khan	1739–1740	Ruled barely a year
Alivardi Khan	1740–1756	Grandfather (maternal) of Siraj-ud-Daulah
Siraj-ud-Daulah	1756–1757	Defeated at Plassey by Robert Clive
Mir Jafar	1757–1760	Installed by the British after Plassey
Mir Qasim	1760–1763	Shifted the capital from Murshidabad to Munger — the only Nawab to move the capital after Murshid Quli Khan

PYQ: Who shifted the Bengal capital from Murshidabad to Munger? **Ans:** Mir Qasim

2 Battle of Plassey (1757) & the Treaty of Alinagar

Before Plassey, **Robert Clive** had already signed the **Treaty of Alinagar** with Siraj-ud-Daulah on **9 February 1757**. "Alinagar" was Siraj-ud-Daulah's own renaming of **Calcutta** after he had captured it in 1756.

Then, on **23 June 1757**, the **Battle of Plassey** was fought — Clive defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah with the decisive help of Siraj's own commander, **Mir Jafar**, who switched sides. Mir Jafar was installed as the new (puppet) Nawab.

Where is Plassey today? Plassey (Palashi) is located in **West Bengal**, on the banks of the Bhagirathi river.

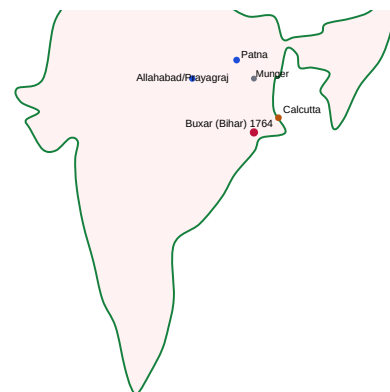
3 Battle of Buxar (1764) — The Real Turning Point



The **Battle of Buxar (22–23 October 1764)** was fought between the East India Company (led by **Hector Munro**) and a **combined force of three Indian rulers**: **Mir Qasim** (Nawab of Bengal), **Shuja-ud-Daulah** (Nawab of Awadh), and the Mughal emperor **Shah Alam II**. The Company won decisively.

Why Buxar matters more than Plassey for "British supremacy": Plassey (1757) was only the *initial foothold* — Clive won mainly through Mir Jafar's betrayal, not military dominance. Buxar (1764) is considered the truly **decisive** battle because its aftermath (the Treaty of Allahabad, 1765) delivered real administrative and revenue power — the Diwani of Bengal — directly into Company hands.

PYQ: Who were Hector Munro's East India Company forces up against at Buxar? **Ans: Mir Qasim, Shah Alam II, and Shuja-ud-Daulah**



Buxar, in modern Bihar — where Company forces defeated a combined army of three rulers on 22–23 Oct 1764.

4 Treaty of Allahabad (1765) & the Diwani



The Treaty of Allahabad was actually **two separate agreements**, both in **August 1765**:

Date	Between	Content
12 August 1765	Mughal emperor Shah Alam II & the British	Grants the Diwani (revenue-collection rights) of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha to the East India Company, in exchange for an annual payment of roughly 26–27 lakh rupees to the emperor
16 August 1765	Shuja-ud-Daulah (Awadh) & the British	Restores most of Awadh to Shuja-ud-Daulah, but under British-friendly terms

Diwani rights = the right to collect tax/revenue. This is the single most important administrative shift in this whole chapter: for the first time, a European trading company became the actual revenue authority over a large Indian province.

Governor at the time: Robert Clive (during his second term as Governor of Bengal) received the Diwani grant on the Company's behalf in 1765 — not Cornwallis (who only arrived in 1786), Wellesley (1798), or Bentinck (1829's Governor-General).

PYQ: Who granted Diwani rights of Bengal to the East India Company in 1765? **Ans: Mughal emperor Shah Alam II**

5 Dual Government (Dyarchy) in Bengal

After 1765, Bengal was run under a **"Dual Government"** — the Company held real power (Diwani/revenue) while a nominal Nawab, **Najm-ud-Daulah**, still sat on the throne (his name is heard in some lectures as "Nizam-ud-Daulah").

- The Company appointed **Mohammad Reza Khan** as **Deputy Diwan (Naib Diwan)** of Murshidabad to actually run the revenue machinery on its behalf.
- This arrangement — power without direct responsibility — led to severe administrative neglect and contributed to the **Bengal Famine of 1770** (a fact worth knowing even though it wasn't in this lecture).

6 First Tribal Contact After the Diwani

Soon after acquiring Diwani rights in 1765, the British began pushing into hill regions and met resistance. Their **first contact and conflict with a hill tribe** was with the **Khasi** people (1760s), in what is today **Meghalaya** — not to be confused with the Kuki people of Manipur.

7 Battle of Wandiwash (1760) — End of French Political Power

The **Third Carnatic War**'s decisive engagement, the **Battle of Wandiwash (1760)**, was fought between the British (commanded by **Sir Eyre Coote**) and the French (commanded by the **Comte de Lally**, who had taken over after **Dupleix** left India in 1756). The British won, and followed up by capturing **Pondicherry in 1761** — effectively ending French political ambitions in India for good.

8 English "Firsts" — Continued

- First English factory on the **Hooghly river: 1651** (a static, non-negotiable date for MCQs).
- First textile mill in India: **Fort Gloster, near Calcutta (Bengal Presidency), 1818** — not Ahmedabad, a very common wrong-option trap.
- First railway line in India: **1853**, from **Bombay to Thane** — **34 km**, under Governor-General **Lord Dalhousie**, who had proposed the railway concept in **1850**.
- Chandernagore (Chandannagar) established as a **French colony in 1673** on the right bank of the Hooghly, with permission from the then Bengal Nawab, **Ibrahim Khan** (not Murshid Quli Khan, who only arrived around 1700).
- Battle of **Swally (1612)**, near Surat — an English naval victory over the Portuguese; it paved the way for Emperor Jahangir granting the English their first permanent factory at Surat the following year (1613).

Why the British beat Indian handicrafts: not because India lacked raw material or skill, but because British industrial-revolution machines produced goods at **lower cost and better/more consistent quality** — a straightforward economics answer, not a resource-scarcity one.

9 Three Presidencies & Where Colonial Rule Began

British India's expansion was organised around **three Presidencies: Bengal, Madras, and Bombay**. Formal colonial administrative rule is considered to have begun first in **Bengal**, because the very first **Governor-General** post was created there.

- British India's capital was **Calcutta** from **1773** until **December 1911**/formally transferred by **December 1912**, when it moved to **Delhi**.

10 The Three Supreme Courts

Supreme Court	Established
Calcutta	1774
Madras	25 December 1800
Bombay	1823

All three were **abolished by the Indian High Courts Act, 1861**, and replaced with regular High Courts.

11 Rohilkhand & the Ryotwari System

In **1772**, the **Marathas** captured **Rohilkhand**. In **1773** (some sources say 1774, since the campaign spanned both years — go with 1773 unless the option set forces otherwise), the **Nawab of Awadh**, with British military help, defeated the Marathas and expelled them from the **Doab region**.

Ryotwari System: "Ryot" means *farmer* — under this land-revenue system, the farmer paid tax **directly** to the British, with no intermediary landlord. Introduced on a trial basis by **Captain Alexander Read** in the **Baramahal region (1792)**, then formally rolled out across **South India** by **Thomas Munro in 1820**.

12 Anglo-Sikh Wars & the Annexation of Punjab

War	Years	Ended by
First Anglo-Sikh War	1845–1846	Treaty of Lahore (1846)
Second Anglo-Sikh War	1848–1849	Full annexation of Punjab (1849)

The final Sikh ruler, the child-king **Maharaja Dalip Singh**, lost to Governor-General **Dalhousie** in the Second War — after which he surrendered the **Kohinoor diamond** to the British and Punjab was fully annexed.

13 Doctrine of Lapse & the Annexation of Awadh

Lord Dalhousie (Governor-General, 1848–56) formally adopted the **Doctrine of Lapse** in **1848**: if a ruler died without a **natural male heir**, the state would be annexed by the Company — an adopted heir would not be recognised.

Year	State annexed under Doctrine of Lapse
1848	Satara (the first state annexed under the doctrine)
1849	Sambalpur, Jaitpur
1852	Udaipur (in present-day Chhattisgarh — not the Rajasthan Udaipur)
1853	Nagpur
1853–54	Jhansi

△ Important nuance the lecture blurs

Awadh (annexed 1856) is technically NOT a Doctrine of Lapse case. Its Nawab, **Wajid Ali Shah**, had natural heirs, so the doctrine could not legally apply. Dalhousie instead annexed Awadh on the separate pretext of "**misgovernance**" — the lecture's own framing (grouping Awadh's 1856 annexation together with the doctrine-based annexations) is the common classroom shorthand, but a careful MCQ may test this distinction directly.

Dalhousie is quoted as having called Awadh "**a cherry that will one day fall into our mouth**" (1851) — and it duly was annexed five years later, in **1856**.

PYQ: Which state's annexation is popularly remembered as "the life going out of the body" (a phrase for the ruler's exile)? **Ans: Awadh, 1856**

14 Subsidiary Alliance (Wellesley)

Lord Wellesley (Governor-General, 1798–1805) introduced the **Subsidiary Alliance** system — Indian rulers had to accept a British Resident and British troops (paid for by the ruler) in exchange for "protection", effectively surrendering independent foreign policy.

- First state to join the Subsidiary Alliance: **Hyderabad, 1798**
- Awadh** was forced into the Subsidiary Alliance in **1801** — decades before its final annexation in 1856

15 First Anglo-Burmese War & Treaty of Yandabo

The **First Anglo-Burmese War** ended with the **Treaty of Yandabo (1826)**, under which the British took control of **Assam** — previously held by Burmese forces.

16 Endgame of the Marathas — Treaty of Mandsaur

The **Treaty of Mandsaur (1818)**, signed by the **Holkar dynasty** with the British, marked the **final battle of the Marathas** (part of the Third Anglo-Maratha War). The major Maratha branches to remember: **Peshwa (Bhat)**, **Scindia (Sindhia)**, **Holkar**, **Bhonsle**, and **Gaekwad**.

Bridge to 1857: Nana Saheb, the rebel leader at Kanpur in 1857, was the adopted son of **Peshwa Baji Rao II** — the last Peshwa, defeated in the Third Anglo-Maratha War.

17 Tiger of Mysore — Tipu Sultan

Tipu Sultan, the "Tiger of Mysore", was killed in **1799** during the **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War**, fought under Governor-General **Lord Wellesley**. The four Mysore Wars, in brief:

War	Years	Treaty	Result
1st	1767–1769	Treaty of Madras	Mysore (Hyder Ali) had the upper hand
2nd	1780–1784	Treaty of Mangalore	Inconclusive/status quo

War	Years	Treaty	Result
3rd	1790–1792	Treaty of Seringapatam	Tipu ceded half his territory; Governor-General: Lord Cornwallis
4th	1799	—	Tipu killed at Seringapatam; Mysore kingdom dismantled; Governor-General: Lord Wellesley

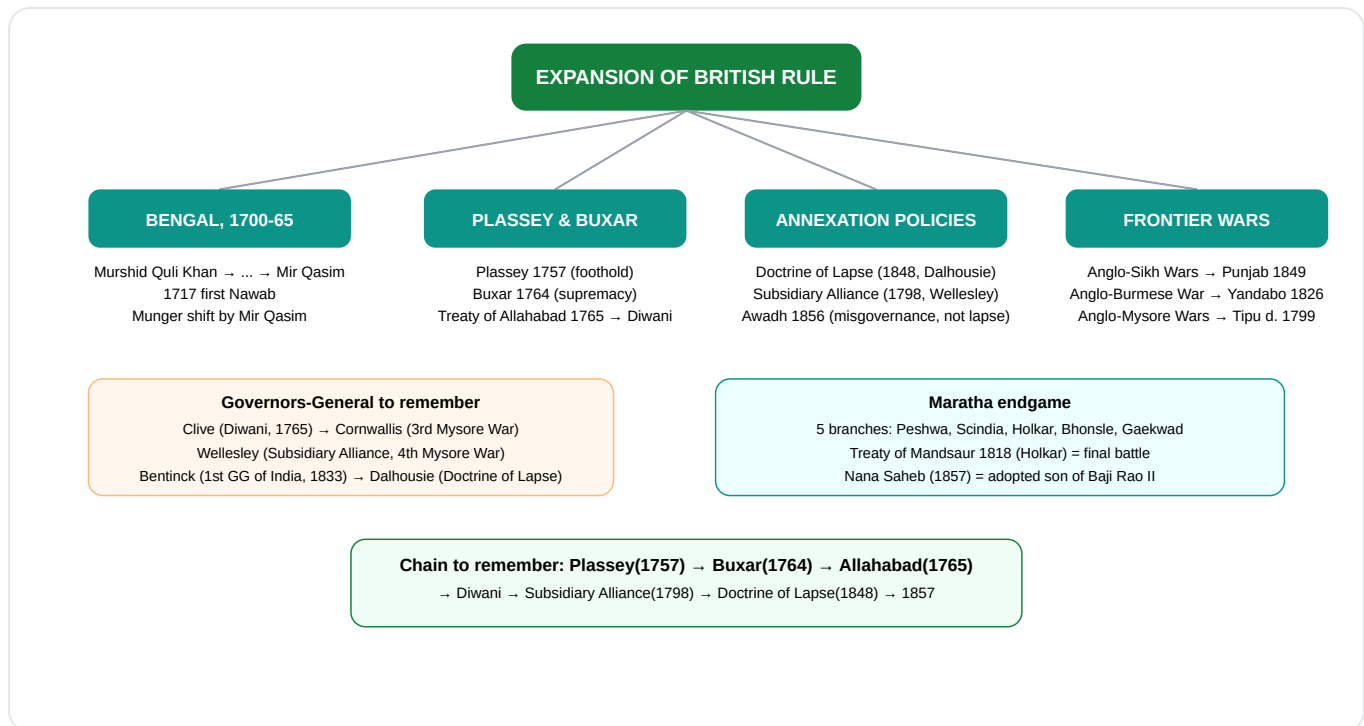
18 Treaty of Amritsar (1809)

Signed between **Charles Metcalfe** (on behalf of the British) and **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** of Punjab in **1809** — it fixed the Sutlej river as the boundary between British territory and the Sikh Empire, keeping peace for decades until the Anglo-Sikh Wars.

19 Master Reference Table

Superlative / Record	Answer
First Nawab of Bengal	Murshid Quli Khan, 1717
Nawab who shifted capital to Munger	Mir Qasim
Battle that began British political presence	Plassey, 1757
Battle that established British supremacy	Buxar, 1764
Treaty that granted Bengal's Diwani	Treaty of Allahabad, 1765
Deputy Diwan of Murshidabad after 1765	Mohammad Reza Khan
First hill tribe the British clashed with post-1765	Khasi (Meghalaya)
Battle ending French power in India	Wandiwash, 1760
First English factory on the Hooghly	1651
First textile mill in India	Fort Gloster, 1818
First railway line in India	Bombay–Thane, 1853 (34 km)
Founder of the Ryotwari System	Thomas Munro, 1820 (trial: Alexander Read, 1792)
First state annexed under Doctrine of Lapse	Satara, 1848
Awadh annexed in	1856 (on grounds of misgovernance, not Doctrine of Lapse)
Introduced the Subsidiary Alliance	Lord Wellesley
First state to accept the Subsidiary Alliance	Hyderabad, 1798
Treaty ending the First Anglo-Burmese War	Treaty of Yandabo, 1826
Final battle of the Marathas	Treaty of Mandsaur, 1818 (Holkars)
"Tiger of Mysore"	Tipu Sultan (d. 1799, 4th Mysore War)
Treaty of Amritsar (1809) signed between	Charles Metcalfe & Ranjit Singh

20 Mind Map — Expansion of British Rule



21 30-Second Revision

Fact	Value
First Nawab of Bengal	Murshid Quli Khan, 1717
Plassey vs Buxar	1757 = foothold; 1764 = supremacy
Treaty of Allahabad	1765; Diwani of Bengal, Bihar, Odisha
Battle ending French power	Wandiwash, 1760
Subsidiary Alliance / first state	Wellesley, 1798 / Hyderabad
Doctrine of Lapse / first state	Dalhousie, 1848 / Satara
Awadh annexed	1856, on misgovernance grounds
Punjab fully annexed	1849, after 2nd Anglo-Sikh War
First railway	Bombay–Thane, 1853

22 PYQs from the Video (with Answers)

1. Who shifted the Bengal capital from Murshidabad to Munger?

Ans: Mir Qasim

2. Which was the most decisive battle establishing British influence in India?

Ans: Battle of Plassey (initial foothold) — but supremacy came via Buxar/Treaty of Allahabad

3. Who is called "the commander born from heaven" (linked to the Treaty of Alinagar)?

Ans: Robert Clive

4. Where is Plassey located today?

Ans: West Bengal

5. Who was the ruler of Delhi (Mughal emperor) at the time of the Battle of Buxar?

Ans: Shah Alam II

6. Who granted Bengal's Diwani rights to the East India Company in 1765?

Ans: Nawab of Bengal / Mughal Emperor — specifically Shah Alam II

7. Under which Governor did the Company receive Diwani rights over Bengal and Bihar from Shah Alam?

Ans: Robert Clive

8. Who was made Deputy Diwan of Murshidabad after the Treaty of Allahabad?

Ans: Mohammad Reza Khan

9. Which hill tribe did the British first come into contact with after gaining Diwani rights in 1765?

Ans: The Khasi (Meghalaya)

10. Which French commander was defeated at the Battle of Wandiwash (1760)?

Ans: Comte de Lally

11. When was the first English factory established on the banks of the Hooghly river?

Ans: 1651

12. India's first railway line ran 34 km from Bombay to which town, in 1853?

Ans: Thane

13. Where did colonial rule first get established among the three Presidencies?

Ans: Bengal

14. In which year did King George III establish the Supreme Court at Madras?

Ans: 1800 (25 December)

15. Where did the English establish a factory on India's east coast in 1611 (which failed)?

Ans: Masulipatnam

16. Which city was British India's capital from 1773 to 1911/1912?

Ans: Calcutta (moved to Delhi in December 1912)

17. Near which town was India's first textile mill established in 1818?

Ans: Fort Gloster (Bengal Presidency)

18. On which river's bank was Bengal's first English factory (1651) established?

Ans: Hooghly river

19. Why did British machine-made goods outcompete Indian handicrafts?

Ans: Lower cost and better/more consistent quality (not raw-material shortage)

20. Which concept did the British introduce in 1850 that reshaped India's economy?

Ans: The railway (proposed by Dalhousie)

21. When did Shuja-ud-Daulah and Shah Alam sign the Treaty of Allahabad with Robert Clive?

Ans: 1765

22. In which year did the British defeat the Marathas in Rohilkhand and expel them from the Doab?

Ans: 1773 (some sources: 1774)

23. Who started the Ryotwari System?

Ans: Thomas Munro (1820); trial basis by Alexander Read (1792, Baramahal)

24. In which year was the First Anglo-Sikh War fought (ending with the Treaty of Lahore)?

Ans: 1845–46

25. When did Lord Dalhousie annex Awadh?

Ans: 1856

26. When was the Subsidiary Alliance treaty imposed on Awadh?

Ans: 1801

27. In which year was the Doctrine of Lapse first applied?

Ans: 1848

28. Who adopted/introduced the Doctrine of Lapse?

Ans: Lord Dalhousie

29. Which act designated the Governor-General of Bengal as the Governor-General of India, and who was first to hold it?

Ans: Charter Act, 1833; William Bentinck

30. In what year did the English East India Company receive Bengal's Diwani rights?

Ans: 1765, after the Treaty of Allahabad

31. Who signed the Treaty of Alinagar with the British?

Ans: Siraj-ud-Daulah

32. What is the old name of Calcutta, given by Siraj-ud-Daulah?

Ans: Alinagar

33. Which region did the British East India Company annex via the Treaty of Yandabo (1826)?

Ans: Assam

34. The Holkar dynasty signed the Treaty of Mandsaur in 1818 — what did it mark?

Ans: The final battle of the Marathas

35. Who is famous as the "Tiger of Mysore"?

Ans: Tipu Sultan

36. In what year was Chandernagore established as a French colony?

Ans: 1673

37. Which Bengal Nawab permitted the French to set up their Chandernagore trading post?

Ans: Ibrahim Khan

38. Who was Bengal's Governor-General during the Third Anglo-Mysore War?

Ans: Lord Cornwallis (2nd Earl Cornwallis)

39. Whose son was Nana Saheb, the Kanpur rebel leader of 1857?

Ans: Peshwa Baji Rao II (adopted son)

40. Who signed the Treaty of Amritsar with Maharaja Ranjit Singh in 1809?

Ans: Charles Metcalfe

41. When was the Battle of Swally fought, and between whom?

Ans: 1612, near Surat, between the English and the Portuguese

23 Extra Practice (Beyond the Video)

E1. Which act formally ended the Doctrine of Lapse, and under which Governor-General/Viceroy?

Ans: Effectively ended by Lord Canning after the 1857 revolt and the 1858 transfer of power to the Crown

E2. What was the exact annual amount paid by the Company to the Mughal emperor under the Treaty of Allahabad?

Ans: Roughly 26 lakh rupees per year

E3. Which event directly followed the Company's dual government / poor administration of Bengal after 1765?

Ans: The Bengal Famine of 1770

E4. Which act (1773) first brought Company rule in Bengal under British Parliamentary oversight?

Ans: The Regulating Act, 1773 (creates the post of Governor-General of Bengal, first held by Warren Hastings)

E5. Was Awadh's 1856 annexation legally a Doctrine of Lapse case?

Ans: No — technically annexed on grounds of "misgovernance", since Nawab Wajid Ali Shah had natural heirs

E6. Who commanded the Company's forces at the Battle of Wandiwash (1760)?

Ans: Sir Eyre Coote

E7. Which princely state's queen, Rani Chennamma, resisted an early "Doctrine of Lapse"-style annexation even before Dalhousie formalised the policy?

Ans: Kittur (1824)

E8. What was the outcome for Maharaja Dalip Singh after the Second Anglo-Sikh War?

Ans: Exiled to Britain; surrendered the Kohinoor diamond

E9. Name all five major Maratha confederacy branches.

Ans: Peshwa (Bhat), Scindia, Holkar, Bhonsle, Gaekwad

E10. In which year and where was the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War fought, and who else assisted the British?

Ans: 1799, Seringapatam; assisted by the Marathas and the Nizam of Hyderabad

24 Bonus — Standard-Syllabus Points (Not in the Video)

These are commonly tested alongside "Expansion of British Rule" but were not explicitly covered in the lecture. Verified against standard references.

- **Regulating Act, 1773:** Created the post of Governor-General of Bengal (first: Warren Hastings) and a Supreme Court at Calcutta — the real starting point of British Parliamentary control over Company rule, and the natural link between "Diwani" and "Doctrine of Lapse" sections of the syllabus.
- **Pitt's India Act, 1784:** Established a Board of Control in London, subjecting the Company's political functions to British government oversight — often paired in MCQs with the Regulating Act.
- **Bengal Famine of 1770:** A direct consequence of the Dual Government system and heavy revenue extraction after the 1765 Diwani grant — killed an estimated one-third of the Bengal population in some regions.
- **Charter Act of 1833:** Ended the East India Company's trading rights entirely (it became purely an administrative body) and created the single post of "Governor-General of India" — first held by Lord William Bentinck.
- **Kittur Rebellion (1824):** Rani Chennamma's resistance to an early lapse-style annexation attempt, predating Dalhousie's formal doctrine by over two decades — a good example for "resistance before 1857" questions.

Cross-check all dates with your NCERT Class VIII "Our Past III" and Class XII Themes in Indian History-III for the standard textbook framing.

This is **Part 2 of an 8-part series** covering the full lecture. Later Mughals are covered next in **Part 3**.